VENTURE ECOSYSTEM

12 firms collected over 50% of all venture cash in the first half of 2025

By Rosie Bradbury

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Co-founder of PayPal, Palantir Technologies and Founders Fund, Peter Thiel. Thiel's Founders Fund has raised more capital than any other VC firm so far in 2025.

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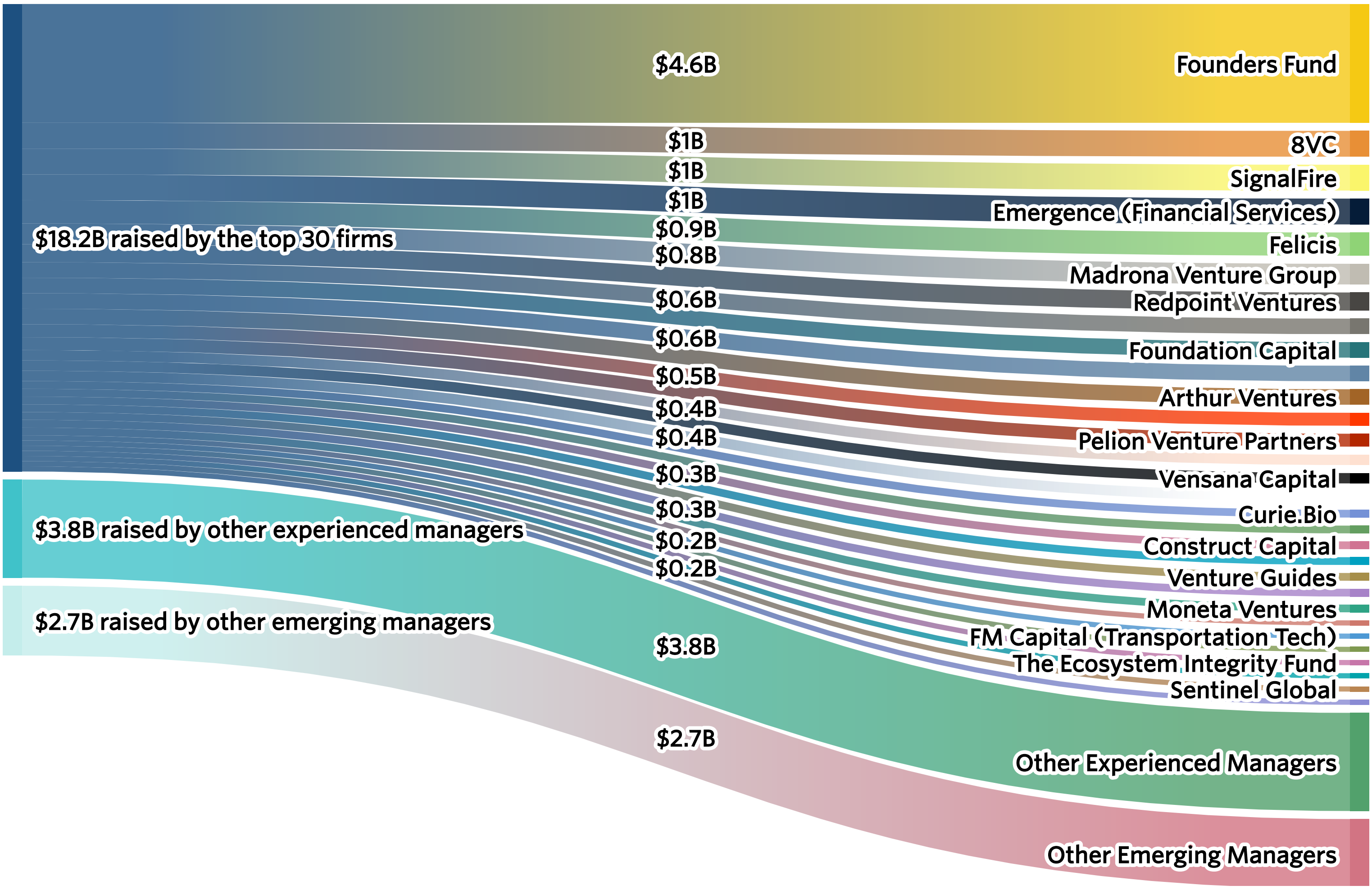
Raising a venture capital fund is still much harder than it used to be—except for the elite firms.

In the first half of this year, just 12 US venture firms raised more than 50% of the total value of capital. And the top 30 firms raised 74% of all capital raised, according to a PitchBook analysis.

Founders Fund reigns in H1 2025



Founders Fund alone raised $4.6 billion in new funds, more than twice what the 44 first-time fund managers collectively raised from LPs so far this year.

Venture capital is continuing its bifurcation between the large, multi-strategy firms accumulating assets at a fast pace, and smaller, boutique fund managers raising more subdued amounts. Fundraising timelines continue to tick up: In 2025, the median time to raise a venture fund reached a record 15.3 months, according to the Q2 2025 PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor.

And the second half of this year is teeing up to be even busier for the big firms: Andreessen Horowitz, Khosla Ventures and Menlo Ventures are all reportedly in talks to raise multi-billion dollar funds. A16z may raise a fund in the range of $20 billion, according to the Financial Times.

Some partners of storied firms, like Sequoia's Matt Miller and NEA's Vanessa Larco, have struck out on their own. But LPs, many of which are still overindexed in venture after two years of sparse exits, aren't necessarily as receptive to making new venture commitments while distributions remain low.

First-time fund managers in particular are having a rough ride. The 44 first-timers who managed to cobble together a fund in 2025 raised a combined total of $1.8 billion, per the Q2 2025 PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor.

About Rosie Bradbury

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter covering startups and venture capital for PitchBook News. Based in New York, she previously reported for the Bureau of Investigative Journalism, Business Insider and Wired. Rosie studied history and politics at the University of Cambridge.

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